

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #014 — Phase 1, Film 5: Lead, Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

SMOKEY

LEAD: Smokey Robinson • RELEASE: Friday, July 20, 2012

Phase 1, Film 5 • The Captain America: The First Avenger role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 • approx. 155 min

A. Why Smokey Robinson

Captain America: The First Avenger is a period piece about the original hero: a skinny kid everyone rejects, chosen by a mentor who sees what he could become, who turns into the loyal heart of the team. In Motown's history, that's Smokey Robinson. He fronted Motown's **first act** and scored its **first million-seller**, and he stayed loyal to Gordy for decades. Memo #009 saved him for his own full-strength film, and this is it.

Captain America	Smokey Robinson (documented history)
The First Avenger	Motown's first act and first million-seller (“Shop Around”)
A skinny kid, rejected	A teenage group turned down at a 1957 audition for Jackie Wilson's management
Dr. Erskine sees his potential	Berry Gordy, at that same audition, hears the songs in Smokey's notebook
Bucky, his lifelong best friend	Ronnie White, childhood friend and Miracles co-founder
Peggy Carter	Claudette Rogers, a Miracle who became his wife (1959)
The Howling Commandos	The Miracles: Ronnie White, Pete Moore, Bobby Rogers, Claudette Rogers and guitarist Marv Tarplin
The loyal heart of the team	Motown's vice president and most trusted creative partner
A period piece, set earliest	Set in the 1950s, the earliest period of any TMU film

B. Release Date: Friday, July 20, 2012

Captain America: The First Avenger opened on Friday, July 22, 2011, 11 weeks after *Thor*. The TMU runs one year behind the MCU and keeps the same 11-week gap, so *Smokey* opens on Friday, July 20, 2012, 11 weeks after *What's Going On*.

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *Smokey*

It's the name he's known by, from a childhood nickname. It's a character-name title, like *Captain America*. To the public, it's a biopic of a legend (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Smokey Robinson with David Ritz, <i>Smokey: Inside My Life</i> (1989)	Smokey's point of view, the Miracles, and Claudette
Berry Gordy, <i>To Be Loved</i> (1994)	The Gordy side of the scenes they share
The master recordings, label credits, and the Billboard chart record	Every song, credit and chart position on screen

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: A skinny kid from Detroit's North End with a notebook full of songs gets turned down, gets chosen, and becomes the first star of Motown and the loyal heart of everything it becomes.

Act One: The Kid (1950s). Smokey grows up in Detroit's North End. He loses his mother at age 10 and fills notebooks with songs. With Ronnie White and friends from Northern High School he forms a vocal group that becomes the Matadors. Claudette Rogers joins when her brother leaves for the Army.

Act Two: Chosen (1957–1960). At a 1957 audition, Jackie Wilson's management turns the group down, but Berry Gordy is in the room and hears Smokey's songs. Renamed the Miracles, they release "Got a Job" (1958). Smokey marries Claudette (1959). They bomb at the Apollo and learn the road the hard way. Smokey pushes Gordy to start his own label, and the Miracles become its first act.

Act Three: The First (1960–1962). Gordy wakes Smokey in the middle of the night to re-record "Shop Around," and it becomes the first million-seller. Smokey becomes Motown's vice president and its most trusted pen. "You've Really Got a Hold on Me" (1962) becomes a hit. In the last scene, the Miracles board a tour bus at Hitsville, late 1962.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

Smokey Robinson's. He's the loyal heart of the Motown Universe, as Captain America is for the Avengers. He's shown at full strength (No-Nerf): the poet, the leader and the friend.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The 1950s music business and the road	Rejection at auditions, tiny payments from other labels, and the grind of the segregated touring circuit. It plays the role HYDRA played for Captain America: a system to beat, not one invented villain.
Internal	Self-doubt	A skinny kid learning to be a leader, a husband and a star all at once.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	Late 1940s (childhood prologue) to late 1962. The fixed points are the 1957 audition, “Got a Job” (1958), his marriage (1959), “Shop Around” (1960–61) and “You’ve Really Got a Hold on Me” (1962).
Where	Detroit’s North End and Northern High School, the 1957 audition, Hitsville U.S.A., and the Apollo Theater in Harlem.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Zero. It begins earlier than any other TMU film and ends exactly where the team-up film begins.

7. Standalone World-Building

Smokey’s world stands on its own: the North End neighborhood, his mother’s loss, the friendships that became the Miracles, his love story with Claudette, and 1950s doo-wop Detroit. It’s a complete story from kid to first star (40% serialized / 60% standalone).

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in Smokey
Returning	Gordy, Raynoma, Esther, the Hitsville sets, and the actors from <i>Hitsville</i> . Smokey is played by the same actor as in Films 1, 2 and 3.
Crossover scenes	The 1957 audition and the middle-of-the-night “Shop Around” call, both seen from Smokey’s side. They match <i>Hitsville</i> exactly (Memo #005).
Seeds	“You’ve Really Got a Hold on Me” is the song the Beatles will cover, which pays off in <i>Hitsville 2</i> . The final bus scene leads straight into the team-up film.

9. Post-Credits Scene: One

Scene	Setting	What happens
End-credits	Hitsville U.S.A., late 1962	Wide shot: the whole Motown roster loads onto the tour buses on West Grand Boulevard. Mary Wells, the Miracles, Marvin Gaye, the Marvelettes, Martha & the Vandellas, the Supremes and Little Stevie Wonder climb aboard. The doors close and the buses pull out. There’s no title card, to keep the secret. This is the TMU’s version of the Avengers teaser that followed <i>Captain America</i> .

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 1, Film 5 of 6. Released July 20, 2012.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 40% serialized / 60% standalone.
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 155 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The same Smokey actor returns, the shared scenes match <i>Hitsville</i> , and it's set earliest on the timeline, ending where the team-up begins.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a Smokey Robinson biopic, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.